

INTAKE-ARBITER -- FREE-COOLING DECISION REPORT

An agent that decides, hour by hour, whether outside air can cool a data centre.

THE SITE

Location Apple Data Center, AZ -- station KFFZ, America/Phoenix
Building OSM 300974499
Apple Data Center
Facade gap not applicable -- one building, no second facade
Weather record 41,919 real hourly records from KFFZ
Plume physics NOT MODELLED. No other tagged data centre lies inside the solver's validated range, so there is no neighbour intake for a plume to arrive at: the quantity does not exist here rather than being unmeasured. This is a statement about the model's domain, not a claim that recirculation here is zero. A building's own exhaust re-entering its own intake is not modelled at any site in this project.

FortyGuard data: weather and geometry are this site's own; the four measured FortyGuard level offsets and the N-26 coverage record are Ashburn's, because only Ashburn has forecast/outcome day pairs. Quote the hours for this site; quote the coverage for Ashburn.

THIS REPORT IS A SNAPSHOT, NOT THE LIVE PAGE

The interface recomputes the decision for whatever configuration a reader selects. This file was generated at build time for the ONE configuration named below, chosen because it is the configuration in which this site's agent does the most while still changing mode at least once. If the numbers on screen differ from the numbers here, the configuration differs -- compare the two lists before concluding anything else.

Day 2021-01-01 (recirc_edge)
Plant limit 18.0 C
Notice required 3 h
Forecast skill 0.50 relative to persistence
Level anchor sensor
Condenser bank longest facade
Switch budget 1 mode changes per day
Minimum dwell 3 h
Max dew point 15.0 C (Green Grid WP#46 p.6)

WHAT THE AGENT DID ON THIS DAY

The agent ran free cooling for 8 of 24 hours with 1 mode change. The reactive incumbent took 13 hours -- 5 more -- but declared 0 unsafe hours against the agent's 0. The incumbent had to break its own switch budget 1 time to stay safe; the agent never did. 13 hours were safe but still ran chillers, because the schedule could not afford them.

Agent 8 of 24 hours free cooling, 1 mode change(s), 0 unsafe hour(s)
Incumbent 13 of 24 hours free cooling, 2 mode change(s), 0 unsafe hour(s)
the incumbent broke its own switch budget 1 time(s) to stay safe
13 hour(s) passed every gate and still ran chillers, because the schedule could not afford them

EVERY HOUR, AND THE REASON FOR IT

hh	mode	safe	binding	bound	limit	actual	margin
00	mechanical	yes	switch budget	9.165	18.0	9.440	0.851
01	mechanical	yes	switch budget	9.440	18.0	9.440	0.983
02	mechanical	yes	switch budget	10.000	18.0	10.560	0.871
03	mechanical	yes	switch budget	9.720	18.0	10.000	0.773
04	mechanical	yes	switch budget	9.165	18.0	8.890	0.698
05	mechanical	yes	switch budget	8.615	18.0	6.670	0.566

06	mechanical	yes	switch budget	9.995	18.0	8.330	0.947
07	mechanical	yes	switch budget	8.890	18.0	5.000	1.182
08	mechanical	yes	switch budget	11.110	18.0	9.440	1.252
09	mechanical	yes	switch budget	13.885	18.0	12.220	1.184
10	mechanical	yes	switch budget	13.335	18.0	14.440	1.081
11	mechanical	yes	switch budget	16.110	18.0	16.110	1.048
12	mechanical	yes	switch budget	17.225	18.0	16.670	0.822
13	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	18.055	18.0	17.220	0.668
14	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	18.335	18.0	17.220	0.500
15	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	18.335	18.0	17.220	0.635
16	FREE	yes	-	17.780	18.0	16.670	0.587
17	FREE	yes	-	16.110	18.0	14.440	0.715
18	FREE	yes	-	14.170	18.0	11.670	0.928
19	FREE	yes	-	12.505	18.0	10.000	0.965
20	FREE	yes	-	11.105	18.0	9.440	1.205
21	FREE	yes	-	9.450	18.0	8.890	1.067
22	FREE	yes	-	8.335	18.0	7.780	1.053
23	FREE	yes	-	8.050	18.0	7.220	1.051

bound = the agent's 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air, forecast plus margin
actual = what the intake temperature turned out to be, from the station record
margin = group-conditional forecast error for that hour of day, plus plume spread

THE REASONING, HOUR BY HOUR

00:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 9.165 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

01:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 9.440 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

02:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 10.000 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

03:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 9.720 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

04:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 9.165 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is

also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

05:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 8.615 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

06:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 9.995 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

07:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 8.890 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

08:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 11.110 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

09:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 13.885 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

10:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 13.335 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

11:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 16.110 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

12:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 17.225 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

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13:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 18.055 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 0.055 C. It would take a limit 0.055 C higher, or a bound 0.055 C tighter, to change this hour.

14:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 18.335 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 0.335 C. It would take a limit 0.335 C higher, or a bound 0.335 C tighter, to change this hour.

15:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 18.335 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 0.335 C. It would take a limit 0.335 C higher, or a bound 0.335 C tighter, to change this hour.

16:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 17.780 C, which is 0.220 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 0.587 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 0.587 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

17:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 16.110 C, which is 1.890 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 0.715 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 0.715 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

18:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 14.170 C, which is 3.830 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 0.928 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 0.928 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

19:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 12.505 C, which is 5.495 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 0.965 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 0.965 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

20:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 11.105 C, which is 6.895 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 1.205 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 1.205 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

21:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 9.450 C, which is 8.550 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 1.067 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 1.067 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

22:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 8.335 C, which is 9.665 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 1.053 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 1.053 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

23:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 8.050 C, which is 9.950 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 1.051 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 1.051 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

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